

JOSEPH KHAOULY

Chief Financial Officer · Commercial Director · AI - Strategy & Finance Transformation

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EU work authorisation | Amsterdam, Netherlands

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Senior finance and commercial executive with 10+ years of C-suite and board-level leadership across infrastructure, heavy engineering, energy, hospitality and advisory businesses in Europe, the Middle East and West Africa. Acted as de facto Group CFO for a seven-company investor portfolio and held commercial ownership within a construction multinational with annual turnover exceeding USD 500 million. Proven track record in capital allocation, debt and equity structuring, cross-border tax and treasury, multi-entity governance, restructuring, and leading complex organisations through growth and transformation.

Today, I combine that executive experience with applied artificial intelligence, supported by executive education at Oxford's Saïd Business School and UT Austin's McCombs School of Business, to design practical AI-powered decision-support systems for finance, investment and business leadership.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Finance & Capital: Corporate finance · Capital allocation · Debt & equity structuring · Treasury & liquidity management · Joint-venture structuring · International & cross-border tax · Financial modelling · Valuation & feasibility · FP&A and forecasting · Zero-based budgeting

Commercial & Operations: Commercial management · Contract administration & negotiation · FIDIC contracting · Cost control & value engineering · Risk allocation · P&L ownership · Shared-services design · Multi-entity consolidation · Post-merger and market-entry set-up

Governance & Transformation: Corporate governance · Internal controls & compliance · Business restructuring & turnaround · Stakeholder and board reporting · Change management · Recruitment and team building

AI & Data: AI strategy · Applied machine learning · Predictive modelling · Decision-support systems · AI governance & responsible deployment · Generative and agentic AI · Data-driven decision-making · Process automation · SQL · Python

Systems: SAP · Tally ERP · Sage BOB · Advanced Excel financial modelling

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder — Joseph Khaouly AI Lab (Research & Product Development) | Independent

Amsterdam, Netherlands | Feb 2025 – Present

Venture and research phase: building AI products to solve executive problems alongside doctoral research.

- Designing and shipping REA, a real estate assistant that automates valuation and portfolio analysis — built from an active investor's perspective.
- Developing S2S Integrity Agent, a construction-finance audit platform reconciling bill-of-quantities, ERP (SAP) and site-log data to surface cost leakage before it compounds.
- Developing CFO Flash, an executive-intelligence tool converting raw financial data into AI-generated decision memos for finance leaders.

Senior Commercial Manager — Infrastructure, Region West | Julius Berger Nigeria Plc

Lagos, Nigeria & Benin Republic | Aug 2023 – Jan 2025

One of Nigeria's largest construction multinationals; group turnover circa USD 500M+ — roughly twenty times the scale of the group previously led.

- Owned commercial strategy, contract administration and financial control for the Region West infrastructure portfolio (highways, bridges, marine and heavy civil works).
- Reduced project overheads by 15% through value engineering, tightened forecasting and disciplined risk allocation, protecting operating margin.
- Contributed to the corporate structuring and operational launch of the company's new branch in the Republic of Benin, extending the group's regional footprint.
- Negotiated complex multi-party contracts, ensuring compliance and balanced risk transfer.
- Declined a promotion and incentives; extended tenure at the company's request to onboard a successor ahead of a planned relocation to Europe.

Personal Advisor to the Chairman & de facto Group CFO | Diversified investor group

Lagos, Nigeria | Feb 2019 – Jul 2023

Direct counsel to the group's majority shareholder across corporate and personal portfolios.

- Co-led negotiations on the USD 75M Signature Tower joint venture — a 232-apartment residential development in Eko Atlantic City.
- Designed and governed a centralised shared-services architecture (Finance, IT, Tax, HR, Procurement) across seven operating companies, delivering holding-company control without incurring Nigeria's double-taxation exposure.
- Advised on investment appraisal, capital budgeting, asset disposals and balance-sheet restructuring across the corporate and personal portfolios.
- Introduced data-driven decision-making into board-level strategy and investment review.

Chief Financial Officer & Director — multi-sector portfolio | Ranjy / RMCK / M&G / The Avenue Suites

Lagos, Nigeria | Apr 2016 – Jul 2023

Concurrent CFO and Board Director mandates across seven companies: heavy civil and façade engineering, energy trading, coal mining, catering and luxury hospitality.

- **Heavy civil & geotechnical** — Directed treasury, banking relationships and debt-financing negotiations for the group's construction and geotechnical businesses (Ranjy Construction & Foundation, RMCK Construction).
- **Capital markets** — Structured, documented and secured regulatory approval for a corporate bond programme on Nigeria's FMDQ Exchange — completing the full issuance process, from mandate through registration, in a market window that ultimately closed to new subscription.
- **Façade engineering** — Secured trade finance and letter-of-credit facilities for international procurement at Metallic & Glazed Facades (subsidiary of Alusteel Lebanon); built internal controls and cash-flow reporting for long-cycle engineering contracts.
- **Hospitality** — As Managing Director & CFO of The Avenue Suites Hotel (Dec 2017 – 2022), secured a multi-year anchor corporate contract through the COVID-19 period, doubling turnover and growing net profit by 60% via zero-based budgeting and profit-centre restructuring.
- **Energy, mining & catering** — Provided financial and operational oversight for diesel trading (RC Energy Resources), coal-mining set-up (Ranjy Energy) and industrial catering (RMCK Catering), converting distressed units into cash-flow-positive operations.

Financial Controller | Albert Khaouly CPA

Beirut, Lebanon | Dec 2014 – Mar 2016

Established certified public accountancy practice specialising in taxation and advisory for SMEs.

- Restructured the firm into four distinct verticals — Accounting, Audit, Tax and Consulting — and rebuilt its operating and brand model.
- Led all advisory work outside the audit and tax scope: feasibility studies, business valuations, business plans and forecasting for SME clients.
- Directed recruitment and HR decision-making as the practice scaled.

EXECUTIVE EDUCATION — AI & ENTERPRISE

AI Foundations for Business Professionals

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford | 2026

Focus: AI strategy, generative and agentic AI systems, enterprise AI governance.

Post-Graduate Programme, AI/ML Business Applications

University of Texas at Austin, McCombs School of Business | 2025 – 2026

ACADEMIC EDUCATION

Master's Degree, Business Science — Financial Analysis & Audit

HEC Liège, University of Liège, Belgium | 2011 – 2014

Thesis: performance measures and key performance indicators in SMEs.

Master's Degree, Business Science — Didactics

HEC Liège, University of Liège, Belgium | 2014

Bachelor's Degree, Accountancy — Management

Haute École de la Province de Liège, Belgium | 2008 – 2011

Graduated 2nd in class · Scholarship recipient · Citizen Award (jury prize).

LANGUAGES & ADDITIONAL

Languages: Arabic (Native) · French (Native) · English (Native-level, C2) · Spanish (Basic, A1)

Additional: Active investor. Available across the EU.